

Jihye Lee

Jihye.l@wustl.edu [Google Scholar](#) [Website](#)

Research Interests

Financial Inclusion, Digital Health, Economic Integration, Multidimensional Poverty, (Forced) Migration, Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA), Artificial Intelligence (AI), Mixed Methodologies

Education

Sep. 2023 – <i>Present</i>	Ph.D., Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis ▪ Advisor: Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.	St. Louis, MO
Aug. 2021	M.S.W., School of Social Work, Chung-Ang University	Seoul, Korea
Feb. 2019	B.A., School of Social Work, Chung-Ang University	Seoul, Korea

Media

June. 2025	IASFM20 podcast ▪ Featured in a conversation with Dr. Naseh and Dr. Akino Tahir about research on the economic integration of resettled refugees in the U.S. (Naseh et al., 2024), emphasizing a multidimensional approach beyond just employment. (Sponsored by WashU and IASFM20). [Link]
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Grants and Fellowships

External Funding, *Rejected*

Jun. 2025 – May. 2026	Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) (\$50,000) ▪ Displaced Livelihoods Initiative (DLI) - Pilot proposal (\$50,000), Role: PI (Jihye Lee), Co-Pi (Mitra Naseh, Ph.D., Patrick Fowler, Ph.D., Zakira Hekmat): Bridging Economic and Mental Health Support: A Community-Informed RCT for Afghan Refugees in Turkey (\$50,000)
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External Fellow, *Awarded*

Jul. 2026	UC Davis Global Migration Center, 2026 Summer School in the Economics of Migration ▪ UC Davis Global Migration Center [LINK]
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Internal Funding, *Awarded*

Nov. 2025	Global Programs, Khinduka Global Professional Development Fund (\$1,000) ▪ Khinduka Global Professional Development fund in Washington University in St. Louis (\$1,000).
2025 – 2027	Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity (\$4,000) ▪ Graduate Fellows Program - Race & Ethnicity Scholar at the Washington University Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity for the 2025-2027 Academic Year [LINK]
Mar. 2025	CFU Graduate Professional Student Council (\$150) ▪ Second Place in Social Science, 30 th Annual Graduate Research Symposium in Washington University in St. Louis [Link] [Link]
Oct. 2024	Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity (\$750) ▪ Graduate Student Conference Travel Award in Washington University in St. Louis [Link]
Jun. 2024 – Jun. 2025	Center for Human Rights, Gender and Migration (\$2,500) ▪ 2024 Seed Grant for two doctoral students in Washington University in St. Louis. Role: PI (Jihye Lee), Co-Pi (Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.): Quality of Life of Highly Educated Iranian Immigrants and Restrictive Migration Policies [Link]
Feb. 2024 – Jun. 2024	Global Programs (\$2,500) ▪ Global Programs Pilot Research Fund in Washington University in St. Louis. Role: PI (Jihye Lee), Co-Pi (Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.): Breaking Barriers: Unraveling the Impact of Financial Aid Policies on Social Mobility for DACA Recipients [Link]

Publications

Refereed Articles

12. [Lee, J.](#), Naseh, M., Zeng, Y & Bechara, S. (In Press). Multidimensional Deprivation and Perceived Discrimination Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. *Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies*.

11. Naseh, M., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y., [Lee, J.](#), & Potocky, M. (2026). Adaptation and Initial Validation of the U.S. Census Multidimensional Deprivation Index for Resettled Afghans (Working Paper No. 01). *Forced Migration Initiative*.
10. Naseh, M., Qushua, N., Nartey, P., [Lee, J.](#) & Razzak, R. B. (In Press) A Scoping Review of Economic Integration Interventions and Programs for Refugees. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.
9. Zeng, Y., Naseh, M., [Lee, J.](#) & Bechara, S. (2026). From First Jobs to Better Pay: Predicting Refugee Wage Mobility with Machine Learning. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*
8. [Lee, J.](#), Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. (2026). Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. *Journal of immigrant and minority health*, 1-11.
7. Taridashti, S., Naseh, M., Garcia, E. M. Z., & [Lee, J.](#) (2025). Health Impacts of Restrictive Migration Policies: A Qualitative Study of Highly Educated Iranian Immigrants and International Students in the U.S. *Journal of immigrant and minority health*, 1-11.
6. Brugger, L., Bellisle, D., Maag, E., Udani, A., Roll, S., Hamilton, L., & [Lee, J.](#) (2025). Child tax credit utilization in immigrant households: a focus on child investment and college funds. *SN Business & Economics*, 5(9), 109.
5. Chung, Y., Maguire-Jack, K., Pei, F., [Lee, J.](#), & Chang, Y (2025). The Mediating Role of Social Cohesion between Neighborhood Disorder and Child Maltreatment Behaviors across Childhood. *Journal of Family Violence*, 1-11.
4. Naseh, M., [Lee, J.](#), Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V., & Safi, M. (2024). Understanding Economic Integration in Immigrant and Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics in the United States. *Economies*, 12(7), 167.
3. Chen, J., Jones, D., [Lee, J.](#), Yan, Y., Hsieh, W. J., Huang, C. H., ... & Drake, B. (2024). Do the benefits of homeownership on mental health vary by race and poverty status? An application of doubly robust estimation for causal inference. *Social Science & Medicine*, 116958.
2. Chang, Y., Maguire-Jack, K., Yoon, S. & [Lee, J.](#) (2022). Family-, school-, and neighborhood- level predictors of resilience for adolescents with a history of maltreatment. *Children* 2023, 10, 1.
1. [Lee, J.](#) & Moon, S. (2022). Analysis of Research Trends in Youth After-school Academy: Focusing on Keyword Network Analysis. *Social Science*, 61(2).

Under Review Publications

11. [Lee, J.](#), Bechara, S, Zeng, Y., & Naseh, M. Multidimensional Poverty among newly resettled refugees in the U.S., evidence from 2019-2021. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*.
10. [Lee, J.](#), Naseh, M., Chen, J., Badiezadeh, S., Zamora Garcia, E. & Chow, C. Reproducing “Liminal Legality” in Academic Discourse: A Social Network Analysis of DACA Research Across Presidential Administrations. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research* [[Under Revision](#)]
9. Yoo, N., [Lee, J.](#), Cureton, A. & Chow, C. Peer Support and Digital Mutual Aid among DACA Recipients Under Liminal Legality: A Computational Text Analysis of Reddit Community. *International Migration Review*
8. Naseh, M., [Lee, J.](#) Badiezadeh, S. & Safi, H. Afghan Refugees’ Conceptions of Economic Integration in the United States. *Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies*.
7. Yoo, N., [Lee, J.](#) & Jang, S. E-Government Engagement and Subjective Well-Being During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Comparing North Korean Refugees and Native Koreans. *Journal of International Migration and Integration*
6. Yoo, N., [Lee, J.](#) & Jang, S. Domain-Specific Patterns of AI Acceptance Among North Korean Refugees and Native South Koreans: A Latent Profile Analysis. *Journal of Psychology and AI*
5. Chow, C. & [Lee, J.](#) Policy models of immigrant political incorporation: Conceptualization and empirical cases in Asian developed economies using fuzzy sets. *The Asian and Pacific Migration Journal*.
4. Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., [Lee, J.](#) & Suarez, C. Social Connectedness as a Social Determinant of Health: A Mixed-Methods Study of Newly Resettled Afghan Refugees in Missouri. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*.
3. Ibrahim, H., Brugger, L., [Lee, J.](#) & Roll S. Disproportionate Economic Hardships of COVID-19 on Immigrant Households. *Journal of Family and Economic Issues*
2. Da Luz Scherf, E., Naseh, M & [Lee, J.](#) Migration Policies as Social Determinants of Health Among International Graduate Students in the United States. *Journal of immigrant and minority health* [[Under Revision](#)]
1. Bechara, S., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y. & [Lee, J.](#), Baker, J. Afghan Refugees’ Multidimensional Deprivation: Comparative Analysis of St. Louis, Portland, and a National Refugee Sample. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research* [[Under Revision](#)]

Under Development

4. [Lee, J.](#), Yoo, N., Min, S. & Kim, Y. Material Hardship and Livelihood Coping Strategies among Refugees in South Korea

3. Naseh, M., Bechara, S., Badiezadeh, S., Baker, J. & **Lee, J.** Structural Barriers in Accessing Employment among Newly Resettled Refugees in the U.S.
2. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.** ... Employed but Still Deprived: Gig work and Multidimensional Poverty Among Resettled Refugees in the United States
1. **Lee, J.**, Bechara, S., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y. & Yoo, N. Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Refugee and Immigrant Support: A Scoping Review

Community Sessions

2. **Lee, J.**, Bechara, S., Zheng, Y., & Naseh, M. (2026). Multidimensional Poverty Among Newly Resettled Refugees in the U.S., Evidence from the Annual Survey of Refugees [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). Community Hearing Session. Clark-Fox Policy Institute, St. Louis, MO. April 1, 2026 [\[Link\]](#) [\[Link\]](#)
1. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, Zheng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V & Safi, M. (2023). Measuring Economic Integration Among Immigrants and Refugees in the US: A Scoping Review [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). ISPN. St. Louis, MO. December 8, 2023.

Conferences

12. **Lee, J.**, Bechara, S., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y. & Yoo, N. (2026). Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Refugee and Immigrant Support: A Scoping Review [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). CERC in Migration and Integration. Toronto, Canada. April 15-17, 2026
11. Yoo, N., **Lee, J.**, Cureton, A. & Chow, C. (2025). Digital Mutual Aid in Precarity: Peer Support Among DACA Recipients on Reddit Across U.S. Administrations [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025
10. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Zeng, Y & Bechara, S. (2025). Multidimensional Deprivation and Discrimination Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025
9. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. (2025). Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025
8. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Ilkkursun, Z., Naseh, M., Acarturk, C., Soylu, N., & Sohtorik Ilkmen, Y. (2025). From Policy Shifts to Lived Health Realities: A Phenomenological Study of Afghan Refugees in Türkiye. [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). Global Health at WashU: Focus on Impact. St. Louis, MO. May 1, 2025.
7. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Bechara, S., & Zeng, Y. (2025). Multidimensional Deprivation Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). Graduate Research Symposium. St. Louis, MO. March 27, 2025.
6. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., & Alvarez, V. (2025). Understanding Economic Integration Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). In Conceptualizing Success and Integration Among Refugees: Perspectives from Research and Practice (Panel). IASFM20: Forced Displacement in an Urbanizing World: Yogyakarta, Indonesia. January 21–23, 2025.
5. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Brugger, L. & Alvarez V. (2024). Towards Integration: Unpacking the Complexities of Multidimensional Economic Integration of Refugees in the U.S. [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). In Conceptualizing Success and Integration Among Refugees: Perspectives from Research and Practice (Panel). IASFM20: Forced Displacement in an Urbanizing World: Yogyakarta, Indonesia. January 21–23, 2025.
4. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V., & Safi, M. (2024). Understanding Economic Integration in Immigrant and Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics in the United States [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). SSWR. Seattle, WA. January 15-19, 2025.
3. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S & Zamora Garcia, E. (2024). Pathways to Economic Integration: A Social Network Analysis of Multidimensional Barriers Faced by DACA Recipients [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). APPAM. National Harbor, MD. November 21 - 23, 2024
2. **Lee, J.** (2024). Exploring Research Trends in Korea's after-School Academy Policy for Youth Using Keyword Network Analysis. [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). SSWR. Washington, DC. January 10-14, 2024.
1. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, Zheng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V & Safi, M. (2023). Measuring Economic Integration Among Immigrants and Refugees in the US: A Scoping Review [\[Oral Presentation\]](#). SSWR. Washington, DC. January 10-14, 2024.

Teaching Experience

Co-Instructor (Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis)

Spring 2026 Evaluation of Program and Services (Online, S50-6001.02) [\[MSW\]](#)

Teaching Assistant (Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis)

Fall 2024 Social Work Practice with Refugees and Immigrants (S31-4100.01) [\[MSW\]](#)

Summer 2024 Evaluation of Program and Services (Online, S50-5050.01) [\[MSW\]](#)

Spring 2024 Policy and Service for Children and Youth (S40-5771.01) [\[MSW\]](#)

Grading Assistant (Art & Sciences - East Asian Languages and Cultures, Washington University in St. Louis)

Spring 2025 Basic Korean (L51-107.01), Korean I (L51-118D.01), Korean II (L51-218)
Fall 2024 Basic Korean (L51-108.01), Korean I (L51-117D.01), Korean II (L51-217)

Guest Lecture

Fall 2025 English Language Programs (ELP – MSW, MPH), *Washington University in St. Louis*
Spring 2024 Human Behavior and the Social Environment (HBSE), *Chung-Ang University*

Academic & Research Experience

Sep. 2023 – <i>Present</i>	The Initiative on Social Work & Forced Migration RA (PI: Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.) St. Louis, MO
	- The protecting role of ethnic networks during COVID-19: A pilot study among Afghan refugees in St. Louis (the Brown School & Centene Corporation COVID & Health Disparity Response Fund) [Link] - Restrictive U.S. Migration Policies Taking a Toll on the Health and Well-Being of Highly Educated Immigrants [Link] - Exploring the Role of Social Position and Administrative Barriers in the Multidimensional Economic Integration of Newly Resettled Afghans in St. Louis (Funded by the WashU Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research) [Link] - Economic Integration of Newly Resettled Afghans Project (Funded by Russel Sage Foundation) [Link]
Sep. 2023 – <i>Present</i>	Center for Innovation in Child Maltreatment Policy, Research and Training RA (PI: Melissa Jonson-Reid, Ph.D.) St. Louis, MO
Mar. 2022 – <i>Present</i>	University of Michigan, Child Maltreatment Prevention Lab RA (PI: Kathryn Maguire-Jack, Ph.D.) Ann Arbor, MI
Dec. 2018 – <i>Present</i>	Korea Institute for Public Administration, Division of Social Cohesion Research RA (PI: Dongjae Jung, Ph.D.) Seoul, Korea
	Contributed to execution and publication of 8 major academic papers commissioned by the government related to refugee and undocumented/immigrant workers in South Korea
Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2023	Journal of the Korean Council for Children's Rights Editorial Research Assistant Seoul, Korea

Field Experience (License: National Certificate of 2nd Grade Social Worker)

Mar. 2019 – Jul. 2023	Sungji Child Welfare Center Social Worker Busan, Korea
	Conducted assessments of essential service needs and interviews for case management.
Mar. 2018 – Jun. 2018 (160 hours in total)	Chung-Ang University Social Welfare Center Social Work Practicum Seoul, Korea
	Assisted in the linkage of community resources such as food banks and academies
Jul. 2017 – Oct. 2017 (160 hours in total)	Moon-Chon 7 Social Welfare Center Social Work Practicum Gyeonggi-do, Korea
	Verify the program's effectiveness through case management for children

Journal Reviewer

2025	Archives of Public Health
2026	Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research
2026	International Migration

Volunteering

Jun. 2025 – <i>Present</i>	1:1 Korean Language and Culture Mentoring for Korean-Americans St. Louis, MO
	Provide weekly 1:1 Zoom mentoring for Korean-Americans, supporting Korean language acquisition, cultural knowledge, and identity exploration.
Sep. 2024	Welcome Neighbor STL St. Louis, MO
	Service support provided through a family visit for a newly settled Afghan refugee family in St. Louis, in collaboration with Welcome Neighbor STL, a community organization supporting newly arrived refugee families with Social Work Practice with Refugees and Immigrants course (Role: TA) [Link]
Jul. 2021 – Nov. 2021	Fund Raising Busan, Korea

- Raised \$12,940 from 526 sponsors across three projects (“Child Have a Dream” and “Grandmothers Have a Dream”) supporting immigrant families and low-literacy seniors.

Mar. 2018 – Mar. 2019 **Chung-Ang University Volunteer Service Award (1st, 3rd)** **Seoul, Korea**
▪ Received the 1st, 3rd prize awarded to those who have contributed to community service awarded by Chung-Ang University.

Professional Membership & Affiliation

2026 – <i>Present</i>	CERC in Migration and Integration
2025 – <i>Present</i>	International Association for the Study of Forced Migration (IASFM20)
2024 – <i>Present</i>	Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity, Graduate Student Affiliates
2023 – <i>Present</i>	Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)
2022 – <i>Present</i>	Society for Social Work and Research (SSWR)

Skills & Certificates

- Data Tools and Programs: STATA, R, Python
- Certified Social Worker (Certificate of Social Worker, Level 2)
- Certified Korean Language Teacher (Certificate of Korean Language, Level 2)